

Friday, May 8

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■ WORLD

One year after the 2025 India–Pakistan conflict, the ceasefire is holding and commercial flights have resumed, but diplomatic normalization remains frozen. India is reportedly preparing a test-fire of its Agni-6 ballistic missile (range up to 10,000 km). ([Washington Post](#), [Manila Times](#))

The US-Iran conflict has effectively closed the Strait of Hormuz, causing fuel and fertilizer prices to spike globally. Agricultural supply chains are rippling beyond the Middle East. ([NPR](#))

President Trump set a July 4 deadline for the EU to ratify a trade agreement, threatening "much higher" tariffs. He also announced 25% tariffs on EU cars and trucks. ([CNBC](#), [Al Jazeera](#))

EU–China tensions are escalating over Chinese industrial overcapacity in steel, EVs, and electronics. Europe's fragmented political will limits its ability to coordinate a unified response. ([Lazard](#))

■ ■ US & POLITICS

The US Court of International Trade struck down a second round of Trump's global tariffs on May 7, ruling that replacement taxes also lack legal basis. The government must now refund over \$166B in duties, with first payments expected next week. ([NPR](#), [KPBS](#))

Special elections in Indiana, Ohio, and Michigan on May 5 showed Democrats outperforming expectations. Michigan: Democrat won a key bellwether state Senate district, extending a special-election win streak. ([PBS NewsHour](#))

Republicans have enacted new congressional maps in 5 states targeting 13 Democratic seats. A WaPo-ABC poll finds a 21-point enthusiasm gap: 73% of Democrats vs. 52% of Republicans call this election more important than past midterms. ([CNN](#))

House Republicans failed to extend a prohibition on Congress canceling Trump's tariff authority, after Rep. Don Bacon and two others broke ranks on constitutional grounds. ([Tax Foundation](#))

■ TECH & AI

Apple plans iOS 27 "Extensions" feature this fall: users will route Siri, Writing Tools, and Apple Intelligence features to Google, Anthropic, or other third-party AI models via Settings. ChatGPT's exclusive slot since iOS 18 opens to all comers across 2 billion devices. ([Bloomberg](#), [TechCrunch](#), [9to5Mac](#))

Apple is in talks with Intel and Samsung as alternate chip suppliers, driven by AI data center demand and stronger-than-expected Mac sales for on-device AI workloads. ([Bloomberg](#))

Apple has disbanded the core Vision Pro development team. The \$3,499 spatial computing device struggled with slow adoption and a thin software ecosystem. No successor device appears imminent. ([Hackaday](#))

◆ FAITH & THEOLOGY

Christians in Israel and Jerusalem report 31 incidents of harassment in the first 3 months of 2026 — spitting, assault, defacing church property — worsening alongside Israel's political shift toward far-right nationalism. ([Al Jazeera](#))

Secretary Rubio met with Pope Leo XIV on May 7, making Christian persecution and religious freedom the central topics — the first formal high-level exchange between the Trump administration and the new pontiff. ([Christianity Today](#)) (commentary)

■ SAN DIEGO

Jacaranda on 9th, an 88-unit affordable housing complex, opened May 7 in downtown San Diego. Most units for households below 25% AMI; 14 units for formerly homeless residents. ([KPBS](#))

Mayor Gloria's FY2027 budget (closing a \$118M deficit) proposes eliminating the traffic safety engineering team, cutting library hours, and freezing arts grants. City Council pushed back at a May 6 hearing. ([KPBS](#), [KPBS](#))

KPBS launched an interactive budget simulator so San Diegans can allocate the \$118M in cuts themselves. Budget negotiations head toward the June 15 deadline. ([KPBS](#))

■ MAKER & CREATIVE ECONOMY

Colossal profiles Fatinha Ramos, whose layered illustrations blend portraiture and "visual activism" — intimate in scale, confrontational in intent. ([Colossal](#))

Ceramicist Maxwell Mustardo sculpts amphorae-inspired vessels in brilliant glazed forms. Colossal documents his months-long, labor-intensive studio practice. ([Colossal](#))

A week-long residency brought 80 international artists to an uninhabited island in Menorca — no audience, no deliverables, only cross-disciplinary work stripped of commercial pressure. ([Colossal](#))

Hackaday May 3 roundup: a quadruped robot dog senior project, plus a reader challenge for hacks powered by ambient energy — solar, kinetic, thermal. ([Hackaday](#))

■ FILMMAKING GEAR

FCC accepting public comments through May 11 on DJI's Covered List appeal. Outcome affects US availability of DJI Ronin rigs and drones. Cinematographers encouraged to file. ([Newsshooter](#))

Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (Matt Damon, Anne Hathaway, Tom Holland, Zendaya) released official IMAX trailer. Shot on large-format film; watched by cinematographers as Nolan's practical-first IMAX pipeline continues. ([Newsshooter](#))

Sony FX6 Firmware v6.0 (March 2026): BIG6 shooting interface from VENICE/BURANO, Blackmagic RAW over HDMI. Ongoing discussion among FX6 operators. [Included as ongoing item; released March 2026.] ([Y.M.Cinema](#))

■ ELECTRIC VEHICLES

VW is skipping the ID.Buzz's 2026 model year in the US, selling down 2025 inventory before the 2027 model arrives later this year. The only fully electric minivan in the US started at \$61,545 for 234 miles of range. VW's US CEO confirmed talks about bringing the camper version to American buyers. ([InsideEVs](#))

Ford unveiled its "Universal Electric Vehicle" (UEV) modular platform from Long Beach, CA — designed to underpin future trucks and commercial EVs, with a goal of moving Model e from losses to breakeven by 2029. ([CNBC](#))

Used EV economics are increasingly favorable as Middle East tensions spike fuel prices. CNBC analysis: energy savings tip clearly toward EVs, though insurance and depreciation vary. ([CNBC](#)) (general EV news)

■ MITO RESEARCH

A case report (Medicine, May 1, 2026) documents MELAS twin brothers with identical m.3243A>G mutations but starkly different outcomes — seizures from age 10 vs. hearing loss then epilepsy at age 12 — and a mother who is asymptomatic at ~31% heteroplasmy. Shows how heteroplasmy distribution shapes phenotype. Discusses anticonvulsant protocols and mitochondrial cocktail (CoQ10, L-arginine, levetiracetam, ATP disodium). Calls for early genetic testing and family screening. ([PubMed](#) · [Medicine](#), May 1)

"The task of pastoral care is not to provide answers to the questions that suffering raises, but to provide a presence that enables people to live faithfully with unanswered questions."

— John Swinton, Raging with Compassion: Pastoral Responses to the Problem of Evil
